

Annual Flowering Plants — Agent-Grade Care Narrative (Priority Tagged)

Purpose: agent-readable horticultural narrative for generating care schedules and cautions. Priority tags: P1=survival-critical, P2=establishment success, P3=optimization, P4=advanced/reference. P1 statements are conservative and exception-aware.

A. Site & Light Requirements (P1)

- Match tag: many bedding annuals require full sun; some prefer shade/part shade.
- Wrong light leads to rapid failure (wilting/scorch) or poor bloom.

B. Temperature & Climate Constraints (P1)

- Plant frost-sensitive annuals only after frost risk has passed.
- Heat stress: in very hot weather, containers may require daily to twice-daily watering.

C. Seasonal Timing / Planting Window (P1)

- For frost-sensitive annuals: plant after last frost and when nights are reliably mild.
- Avoid planting into cold, saturated soil; growth stalls and roots rot.
- Mid-summer planting is high-risk without consistent irrigation/shade management.

D. Watering & Moisture Profile (Day 0–30) (P1)

- Water in immediately after planting; ensure full root ball saturation.
- Week 1: keep evenly moist (not soggy); check daily (containers may need 1–2 checks/day).
- After week 1: water when top ~1 inch is dry; water thoroughly until excess drains (containers).
- Water at base; avoid routine overhead watering late day.

E. Soil Requirements (P2)

- Loose, well-drained soil; containers must have drainage holes.
- Mulch reduces evaporation in beds.

F. Planting & Installation Rules (P1)

- Plant at same depth as in the pot unless species-specific guidance says otherwise.
- Space for airflow; reduce fungal risk.

G. Fertilization Guidance (P2)

- If soil was not pre-fertilized, a dilute starter solution can be applied about 1 week after transplanting (or per label).
- Avoid fertilizing dry soil; water first. Avoid over-application (burn risk).

H. Pest & Disease Risk (Early Window) (P2)

- Aphids/whiteflies: begin with water spray and removal of heavily infested tips.

- Humidity + wet foliage increases disease; prefer morning base-watering.

I. Weed Competition Sensitivity (P2)

- Remove weeds early; mulch where appropriate.

J. Weather Exception Handling (P1)

- Heat wave: increase watering frequency; provide afternoon shade for heat-sensitive annuals; prioritize morning watering.
- Heavy rain: prevent waterlogging; ensure drainage; move containers under cover if possible.
- Cold snap: cover overnight; avoid planting right before a forecast freeze.

K. Growth & Establishment Signals (P2)

- Normal: mild wilt on first day; recovery after watering within hours.
- Concerning: repeated wilt despite moist soil, stem collapse, leaf scorch expanding daily.

L. Safety & Customer Guardrails (P1)

- Never let most containers sit in standing water.
- Do not fertilize dry soil; water first.

M. Location-Based Modifiers (P2)

- Arid/windy: higher evaporation—mulch and wind protection matter.
- Humid/coastal: prioritize spacing/airflow and morning watering.

N. Lifecycle Transition (Post 30 Days) (P4)

- Move to species-specific maintenance feeding and deadheading schedules.